

Tonya Nguyen, Ph.D.

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Interests: Human-AI Interaction, Evaluation of AI Systems, Responsible AI, Social Computing, AI Policy & Governance, Human Data

SKILLS

Research	Qualitative Methods, Quantitative Methods, Controlled Experiments, Participatory Methods, Prototyping & Design
Technical	Python, post-training techniques (scikit-learn, NumPy, pandas; PyTorch, huggingface), Data Visualization (matplotlib/seaborn; plot.ly)

EDUCATION

2020 – 2026	University of California, Berkeley PhD, Information Science <i>Advisor:</i> Niloufar Salehi
2016 – 2020	University of California, Berkeley BA, Interdisciplinary Studies Field Coursework in Computer Science, Design Innovation, Critical Theory

ACADEMIC EMPLOYMENT

2026 – Ongoing	Stanford University, Computer Science Postdoctoral Researcher <i>Advisor:</i> James Landay
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INDUSTRY EXPERIENCE

2026	Handshake AI Senior Researcher Focus on RLE, data quality, and taxonomy
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2025 Microsoft

Research Intern, FATE and STAC Group
Advisors: Jennifer Wortman Vaughan, Jean Garcia-Gathright

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

2020 – 2026 Tech of One's Own Lab (TO3)

Graduate Research Assistant, UC Berkeley
Advisor: Niloufar Salehi

2020 – 2021 Berkeley Center for Law & Technology

Research Assistant
Advisor: Richmond Wong

2019 – 2020 Stanford Human Computer Interaction

Research Assistant
Advisors: Mark Whiting, Michael Bernstein

2018 – 2020 Berkeley Institute of Design

Research Assistant
Advisors: Jeremy Warner, Björn Hartmann

PUBLICATIONS

FACCT '26 *Validating and Refining Generative AI Evaluations via Stakeholder Engagement*

Tonya Nguyen, Jean Garcia-Gathright, Hannah Washington,
Alex Chouldechova, Hanna Wallach, Jennifer Wortman Vaughan

CHI '25 *"It Actually Doesn't Feel Very Mutual:" How Technology Impacts the Values of Mutual Aid Groups in Practice*

Tonya Nguyen, Darya Kaviani, Niloufar Salehi

CSCW '24 *Definitions of Fairness Differ Across Socioeconomic Groups & Shape*

Perceptions of Algorithmic Decisions

Tonya Nguyen, Sabriya Alam, Cathy Hu, Catherine Albiston, Niloufar Salehi.

- CHI '23 *Expressiveness, Cost, and Collectivism: How the Design of Preference Languages Shapes Participation in Algorithmic Decision-Making*
- Samantha Robertson, **Tonya Nguyen**, Cathy Hu, Catherine Albiston, Afshin Nikzad, Niloufar Salehi
- IUI '23 *SlideSpecs: Automatic and Interactive Presentation Feedback Collation*
- Jeremy Warner, Amy Pavel, **Tonya Nguyen**, Maneesh Agrawala, Björn Hartmann
- CSCW '22 *Not Another School Resource Map: Meeting Underserved Families' Information Needs Requires Trusting Relationships and Personalized Care*
- Samantha Robertson, **Tonya Nguyen**, Niloufar Salehi
- CHI '21 *Modeling Assumptions Clash with the Real World: Why Student Assignment Algorithms Have Not Realized Theoretical Values of Transparency, Equity, and Efficiency*
- Samantha Robertson, **Tonya Nguyen**, Niloufar Salehi
- CHI '21 *Timelines: A Speculative World-Building Activity for Discussing Values and Ethics*
- Richmond Wong, **Tonya Nguyen**
- CHI '20 *Implications of Conversational Artificial Intelligence*
Workshop Paper: Fair Artificial Intelligence
- Tonya Nguyen**, Niloufar Salehi
- CHI LBW '19 *"I Almost Fell in Love with a Machine": Speaking with Computers Affects Self-disclosure*
- Qian Yu, **Tonya Nguyen**, Sorivas Prakkamakul, Niloufar Salehi

WORKING PAPERS

2026	User Interaction Models for Control and Alignment in GenAI Memory Management
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Tonya Nguyen, Donghoon Shin, Gary Hsieh, Lucy Lu Wang

2026	How Explanations and Political Frames Shape Perceptions of Algorithmic Social Policies
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Tonya Nguyen, Liza Gak, Cathy Hu, Catherine Albiston, Niloufar Salehi

GRANTS, FELLOWSHIPS, AND AWARDS

2025	\$30,000 – UC Dissertation Fellowship
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2022 Diversity and Inclusion Award, ACM CSCW

2022	\$100,000 – Meta Research Grant for Fairness in Two-Sided Markets Author of Proposal
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2022 NSF GRFP Honorable Mention Recipient

2021	\$750,000 – NSF Grant for Designing & Evaluating Software Systems to Advance Equal Opportunity
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2021	\$2000 – Center for Technology, Society, & Policy Fellowship
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2020	\$5000 – Berkeley Center for New Media Research Grant
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TEACHING

2021 Tangible User Interfaces
Head Graduate Instructor

Instructor: Kimiko Ryokai

2020 User Interface Design & Development (CS 160 / INFO 213)
Head Undergraduate Instructor

Instructor: Niloufar Salehi

2019 Beyond Design Thinking – Democratic Learning at Cal (DeCal)
Co-Instructors: Lian Song, Mars Wu, Kevin Pham

WORKSHOP & PANEL ORGANIZING

4S '25 Sociotechnical Perspectives on Public Interest Technology
Society for the Social Studies of Science (4S)

Lauren Chambers, Cedric Deslandes Whitney, **Tonya Nguyen**,
Morgan Ames, Deirdre Mulligan

CSCW '24 Case Studies in Public Interest Technology: Bridging Research & Practice

Lauren Chambers, Nasser Eledroos, **Tonya Nguyen**, Cedric Deslandes
Whitney, Dan Bateyko, Jared Katzman

CSCW '22 Who has an interest in “Public Sector Technology”? Critical questions for
working with local governments & impacted communities

Logan Stapleton, Devansh Saxena, Anna Kawakami, Tonya Nguyen,
Asbjørn Ammitzbøll Flügge, Motahhare Eslami, Naja Holten Møller, Min
Kyung Lee, Shion Guha, Kenneth Holstein, Haiyi Zhu

SERVICE

2026 – present Associate Chair (AC) for CHI 2026 – Critical Computing Track

2024 – 2025 PhD Student Representative at the UC Berkeley iSchool

2022 – present ACM FAccT Program Committee

2022 – present ACM CHI Reviewer

2022 – present ACM CSCW Reviewer

2021 – 2026 PhD Application Feedback Program
UC Berkeley iSchool

TALKS AND PANELS

2026 *Rich Evaluations of Sociotechnical Systems and AI*
Stanford HCI Group, at Stanford University

- 2025 *How Stakeholder Evaluation Can Improve Measurement*
Microsoft Research STAC, Remote
- 2025 *Participatory Design Can Improve AI Science and Evaluation*
Pareto AI Headquarters, in San Francisco, CA
- 2025 *Measuring Representational Harms in GenAI*
Microsoft Research, in New York City, New York
- 2025 *It Actually Doesn't Feel Very Mutual: How Technology Impacts
The Values of Mutual Aid Groups in Practice*
CHI 2025, in Yokohama, Japan
- 2024 *The Values We Live By: Enactment, Alignment, and Politics In
Sociotechnical Systems*
Qualifying Exam, at UC Berkeley
- 2024 *Definitions of Fairness Differ Across Socioeconomic Groups &
Shape Perceptions of Algorithmic Decisions*
CSCW 2024, in San José, Costa Rica
- 2024 *Sociotechnical Perspectives on Public Interest Technology*
4S 2024, in Seattle, Washington
- 2024 *Evaluating Expectation Violation Theory in Public School Assignment*
Guest Lecture, Data Science 241: Experiments and Causal Inference,
at UC Berkeley
- 2023 *Algorithmic School Assignment and Its Limitations*
Guest Lecture, in Information 203, Social Issues of Information, at UC Berkeley
- 2022 *Democratic Engagement & Procedural Justice in Algorithmic School Assignment*
SREE 2022, in Washington, D.C.
- 2022 *Solidarity, not Charity!: Understanding Social Movements Online*
Center for Technology, Society, and Policy, at UC Berkeley
- 2019 *Scaled Humanity: How Task Design and Context Impacts Online Collaborative
Dynamics*
Stanford HCI Group, at Stanford University
- 2019 *Feminist HCI and Postcolonial Computing*
Stanford HCI Group, at Stanford University